Anastasia Kokori

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Curriculum Vitae

Education

- **PhD candidate in Astronomy** September 2023 – today
  Department of Physics and Astronomy, University College of London, UK.
  Supervisor: Prof Giovanna Tinetti.
- **BSc in Planetary Science with Astronomy (first class)** October 2018 – September 2022
  Department of Earth and Planetary Sciences, Birkbeck University of London, UK.
  Thesis: Understanding exoplanets through the Solar System: The case study of Venus.
  Supervisor: Prof Hilary Downes.
- **Space Studies Program (A^-)** June 2018 – August 2018
  International Space University.
  Department: Engineering. Team project: *Space-aided Climate Change Adaptation*.
- **MSc in Science Communication (2:1)** September 2016 – September 2017
  School of Communications, Dublin City University, Ireland.
  Thesis: *Engaging society with science: The case of Danakil Depression.*
  Supervisors: Dr. Padraig Murphy and Dr. Pedro Russo.
- **BA (Ptyhion) in Primary Education (9.18/10.00)** September 2011 – July 2015
  School of Primary Education, Aristotle University of Thessaloniki, Greece.
  Thesis: *Exoplanetary systems*. Supervisor: Prof. Stavros Avgoloupis.
- **Journalism Diploma (9.00/10.00)** September 2013 – July 2016
  IEK "XINI", Thessaloniki, Greece.

Scholarships & Awards

- **UCL Open Science and Scholarship Awards** October 2025
  Honourable Mention in the Category: Activities led by academic staff or PhD students: Open publishing.
- **UCL MAPS Faculty Early Career Researchers Forum Awards** August 2025
  Outreach and Communication Award
- **Research Excellence Scholarship** September 2023
  University College of London – full PhD Scholarship.
- **Outreach and Engagement Award** June 2023
  Center for Planetary Sciences at UCL – individual(newcomer) award.
- **Aleksander Silberfeld Prize** November 2022
  BSc Planetary Science with Astronomy – award for the Highest Mark.
- **10th Postgraduate International School of Volcanology** October 2022
  Scholarship to attend, Olot, Spain.
- **The "VolcanoCamp" by GeoTenerife** June 2022
  Scholarship to attend, Canary Islands, Spain.
- **Emily Paige Short Funding** June 2022
  Birkbeck University, London, UK.
- **Mineralogical Society of Great Britain and Ireland Student Award** May 2020
  for the second-year student with the highest ranking marks in Mineralogy and Petrology.
- **ESA Scholarship** for attending the Space Studies Program. May 2018

- **IEK "XINI" Scholarship** for attending the Journalism Diploma. May 2012

Work experience

- **Public Engagement Officer** July 2019 – Sep 2025
  UCL-CSED, London, UK.
- **Astrographic Officer** December 2018 – June 2021
  Royal Observatory Greenwich, London, UK.
- **Observatory Explainer**
  - Royal Observatory Greenwich, London, UK. November 2018 – June 2021
  - Blackrock Castle Observatory, Cork, Ireland. May 2017 – August 2017
  - Holomon Astronomical Station, Greece. June 2014 – August 2016
- **Science communicator**
  - Press assistant in the EGU General Assembly 2019, Vienna, Austria. April 2019
  - Intern at UCL (exoplanets group), London, UK. December 2017 – May 2018
  - Co-operation with the astrophysics group at UCL November 2017
    in the context of the Europlanet Special Expert Exchange Program
    for Science Journalists/Science Communicators, London, UK.
  - Part of the evaluation team for the Dublin Maker event, Dublin, Ireland. July 2017
  - Part of the evaluation team for the September 2017
    European Researchers' Night (Probe), Trinity College Dublin, Ireland.
- **Europlanet Early Career (EPEC) Network**: Outreach chair September 2019-2023
  (link).
- **Journalist** December 2015 – June 2016
  TV channel "TV100", Thessaloniki, Greece.
- **Teacher** January 2015 – May 2015
  105° Public primary school, Thessaloniki, Greece.

Current projects

- **Ariel Space Mission**:

  - Co-Coordinator of Ephemerides working group on Ariel and of the ExoClock project, involving over 2000 professional and amateur astronomers from 65 countries around the world, with the aim of monitoring transiting exoplanets.

  - Coordinator of the ArielEDU program aiming to promote exoplanet activities and the Ariel mission in schools.
- **Open Science and Citizen Science**:

  - Creator of ExoWorlds Spies, an open platform aiming to provide educational material and exoplanet research to amateur astronomers, schools and the general public.

  - Founder of ExoClock Unlocked, a project aiming to provide opportunities and training to members that dont have access to observing facilities.
- **Pulsar Non-Profit Civil Company**:

  - Founder of Pulsar, a non-profit civil company based in Greece aiming to open science to diverse communities.

  - Organizer of outreach events, educational seminars, and science activities designed for schools and the general public.

- **Outreach and Education**:

  - **Public Engagement**: Giving frequent public talks, interactive seminars, and organizing open science events to make astronomy accessible to the general public, including an invited talk at TEDxLamia 2026 ("The journey of light: from the big bang until today").

  - **Educational Activities**: Designing and delivering tailored educational workshops, school visits, and hands-on astronomy activities for kids and students.

  - **Citizen Science for Everyone**: Creating and supporting open-access platforms that allow citizens from all backgrounds, regardless of experience or equipment, to actively participate in real-world exoplanet research.

- **Indicative Highlights**:

  - **Science Centers & Museums**: Invited public speaker and science communicator at key venues, including the NOESIS Science Center and Technology Museum.

  - **Art & Creative Mediums**: Utilizing art (e.g., experiencing the mysterious nature of exoplanets through painting) as an innovative tool for public outreach.

  - **Children's Books**: Author of a children's book designed to introduce younger audiences to astronomy and space exploration.

  - **Digital Science Communication**: Creating engaging video content for social media platforms to simplify complex astronomical concepts and reach wider online audiences.

  - **Inclusive Science Initiatives**: Providing training and observation opportunities to communities and amateur astronomers who lack access to professional facilities.

Publications

- A. Kokori et al., 2026, ExoClock Unlocked: A project to increase public participation in exoplanet research. RAS Techniques and Instruments, rzag072.
- A.Kokori et al, 2026, ExoClock Project. IV. A Homogeneous Catalog of 620 Updated Exoplanet Ephemerides. The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series.
- D. Albergaria et al., 2026, The Search for Life Elsewhere: Avoiding Hype and Fostering Public Understanding. Astrobiology, 26(9), 667-676.
- S. R. Hagey et al., 2025, TrES-1b: A Case Study in Detecting Secular Evolution of Exoplanet Orbits. arXiv preprint arXiv:2508.15075.
- A.Kokori, 2024, Measuring an exoplanet, AstroEDU, 2409.
- A.Kokori et al, 2022, ExoClock Project III: 450 new exoplanet ephemerides from ground and space observations. The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series,in press.
- A.Kokori et al, 2022, ExoClock project II: A large-scale integrated study with 180 updated exoplanet ephemerides. The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series 258 40.
- A. Kokori et. al, 2022, ExoClock Project: An open platform for monitoring the ephemerides of ARIEL targets with contributions from the public. Experimental Astronomy.
- G. Tinetti et al. 2021, Ariel: Enabling planetary science across light-years, Ariel Definition Study Report, Reviewed by ESA Science Advisory Structure in November 2020 (link).
- K. Pearson et al. 2022, Utilizing a Global Network of Telescopes to Update the Ephemeris for the Highly Eccentric Planet HD 80606 b and to Ensure the Efficient Scheduling of JWST. The Astronomical Journal, 146, 5.
- B. Edwards et al. 2021, Original Research By Young Twinkle Students (ORBYTS): Ephemeris Refinement of Transiting Exoplanets III. Astronomy Theory, Observations and methods 2(1).

- B. Edwards et al. 2021, Original Research By Young Twinkle Students (ORBYTS): Ephemeris Refinement of Transiting Exoplanets II. RNAAS 4(7) 109.
- B. Edwards et. al, 2020, Original Research By Young Twinkle Students (ORBYTS): Ephemeris Refinement of Transiting Exoplanets. MNRAS 500(4) 5671-5684.

Press Releases

- ExoClock Counts Down Ariel Exoplanet Targets. Europlanet, September 2022.

Conferences

- 7th Shaw-IAU Workshop on Astronomy for Education, Online. November 2025.
  - Exoplanets In The Classroom By Using Hands-On Activities (talk)
- EPSC-DPS Joint Meeting 2025, Helsinki, Finland. September 2025.
  - Open planetary science for effective knowledge co-creation and dissemination (convener)
  - Integrating data from ground-based and space telescopes to support future space missions in the new exoplanet era: The case of the ExoClock project (talk)
- EPSC2024,Berlin, Germany. September 2024.
  - Open planetary science for effective knowledge co-creation and dissemination (convener)
  - Communicating Planetary Science in the 21st century (co-convener)
  - The ExoClock project for the Ariel space mission- 5 years of continuous operation (talk)
  - Astrotourism as a tool for astronomy and planetary science outreach - The case study of Ikaria island (talk)
- Lorentz Center workshop on Astrobiology Communication 2024, Leiden, Netherlands, September 2024.
  - Workshop organised from Leiden University, the Earth-Life Science Institute (ELSI), and NASA Astrobiology(invited attendee)
- Japanese Geoscience Union Meeting 2024, Chiba, Japan, May 2024.
  - The ExoClock Project: an open integrated and interactive platform to continuous monitor the targets of the Ariel space mission(ivited talk)
- 6th Chianti Topics: Use of small telescopes in the giant era II, Florence, Italy, February 2024.
  - Re-inventing the use of small telescopes in the new exoplanet era: Lessons learned from the ExoClock project (ivited talk)
- EPSC2022, Granada, Spain. September 2022.
  - Open planetary science for effective knowledge co-creation and dissemination (convener)
  - Exoclock and Amateur Astronomy contribution Exoplanet Science (convener)
  - Professional-Amateur collaborations in small bodies, terrestrial and giant planets, exoplanets, and ground-based support of space missions (co-convener)
  - ExoClock project: a pro-am collaboration to monitor the exoplanet ephemerides for the Ariel space mission (talk)
- EPSC2021, online. September 2021.
  - Open science: The framework towards democratising science (keynote talk)
  - Open planetary science for effective knowledge co-creation and dissemination (convener)
  - The ExoClock Project: an open integrated and interactive platform to continuous monitor the targets of the Ariel space mission (talk)
- EPSC2020, online. September 2020.
  - Open planetary science for effective knowledge co-creation and dissemination (convener)
  - The Ariel mission for exoplanets and support from amateurs (convener)
  - Professional-Amateur collaborations in small bodies, terrestrial and giant planets, exoplanets, and ground-based support of space missions (co-convener)

  - The ExoClock Project: an open integrated platform for maintaining the Ariel target ephemerides with contributions from the public (talk)

- EPSC2019, Geneva, Switzerland. September 2019.
  - The solar system and beyond: communicating planetary science in society (co-convener)
  - Ground-based exoplanet observations in support of the ARIEL space mission (talk)
  - ExoWorlds Spies: a research project as a vehicle for outreach and education (talk)
  - Experiencing the mysterious nature of exoplanets through painting (poster)

- 14th Hellenic Astronomical Conference, Volos, Greece. July 2019.
  Ground-based exoplanet observations in support of the ARIEL space mission (talk)

- EPSC2018, Berlin, Germany. September 2018.
  - Danakil Depression: A natural laboratory as a vehicle for astrobiology outreach (talk)
  - ExoWorlds Spies: a project for public involvement in exoplanet research (poster)
  - Follow-up observations of transiting exoplanets: data collection and analysis (poster)

- 2nd Symposium on Space and Educational Activities, Budapest, Hungary. April 2018.
  Increasing public participation in exoplanetary research through Citizen Science and user-friendly tools (p32, poster)

- EPSC2017, Riga, Latvia. September 2017.
  Developing a user-friendly photometric software for exoplanets to increase participation in Citizen Science (talk)

- 13th Hellenic Astronomical Conference, Herakleion, Greece. July 2017.
  - The Holomon Astronomical Station (poster)
  - Follow-up observations of transiting exoplanets with small telescopes (poster)
  - Observation of variable stars from Holomon Astronomical Station (poster)

- 12th Hellenic Astronomical Conference, Thessaloniki, Greece. July 2015.
  The effects of defocused photometry on exoplanet transit light-curves (poster)

- **Ariel Consortium Meetings:**

  - Ariel Autumn Consortium Meeting, Vienna, Austria (September 2026)
    ExoClock updates and status (talk).
  - Ariel Open Conference 2026, Harwell Campus, UK (March 2026)
    ExoClock updates and status (talk).
  - Ariel Consortium Meeting - Fall 2025, Madrid, Spain (September–October 2025)
    ExoClock project progress and community coordination (talk).
  - Ariel Consortium Meeting - Spring 2025, Tartu, Estonia (April 2025)
    Maintaining the observing schedule and transit ephemerides via ExoClock (talk).
  - Ariel Consortium Meeting - Fall 2024, Lisbon, Portugal (October 2024)
    Update on ArielEDU and ExoClock integration for school activities (talk/presentation).
  - Ariel Consortium Meeting - Fall 2023, Budapest, Hungary (October 2023)
    ExoClock community statistics and ground-based support strategies (talk).
  - Ariel Consortium Meeting - Spring 2021, Online (June 2021)
    Coordinating the international professional-amateur network (talk).
  - ARIEL: Science, Mission & Community 2020 Conference, Online (January 2020)
    ExoClock: An open integrated platform for defining the ephemerides of ARIEL targets (talk).

Skills

- **Observational Astronomy**
  - Astronomical data collection, reduction, photometry and analysis of light-curves using MaxImDL, AstroImageJ and Python-based software.

  - Hundreds of observing hours with small- and medium-scale telescopes (10 to 24″).

- **Outreach / Tutoring**
  - Developing social media material and strategies (Exoworlds Spies on Facebook)
  - Writing articles for international media on astronomy and space:
    * Space missions looking at worlds beyond the Earth
    * We've said goodbye to Cassini. What comes next?
  - Giving live planetarium shows and leading workshops with participants of all ages, backgrounds and nationalities at Blackrock Castle Observatory in Cork, Ireland.
  - Astronomy tutor to high-school students at the Observatory of the Aristotle University of Thessaloniki, Greece.
  - Astronomy tutor and organiser of astronomical projects in primary schools and summer camps with children in Greece since 2013.
  - Giving frequent public talks and writing articles on astronomical subjects.
  - Supervising MSc students and assisting classes in university courses at UCL.

- **Journalism**
  - Editing text and articles, photo-reportage, techniques of communication and interview

- **Computing**
  - Operating systems: familiar with Linux and Windows (ECDL certificate).
  - Programming: basic skills of programming in Python.

- **Languages**
  - Greek (native), English (proficient), Spanish (fluent), Turkish (fluent)

- **Evaluating science outreach events**
  - Data gathering across a range of public issues (e.g. attitudes towards European research).
  - Recording participant responses using bespoke digital tools.
  - Ensuring compliance with established survey protocols.
  - Liaising with a team of evaluators to ensure effective survey implementation.